PRIORITY 30 OF 33 · SCORE 2.0

AmeriCorps

AmeriCorps is small, but one of its programs has one of the highest reported error rates in government: the Foster Grandparent Program at 23.6% (FY2025). The usual problems are stipend and timesheet fraud and grantees that cannot support costs. Public data can rank grantees, not members.

INVESTIGATIONS WE PROPOSE

CNCS-1 Foster Grandparent and State and National grantees with prior findings or high cost per member. **First prototype.**

CNCS-2 Form 990 revenue checks.

EXPOSURE

- $1.2B in outlays in FY2026.
- Foster Grandparent Program: 23.6% improper payment rate (GAO, FY2025).

PUBLIC DATA WE USE

- **USAspending grants** to AmeriCorps grantees and subgrantees.
- **AmeriCorps OIG** reports and investigations.
- **SAM.gov** exclusions; IRS Form 990 data for nonprofit grantees.

HOW WE DETECT IT

1. **Grantee risk:** grantees with prior OIG findings, shared officers across grantees, or rapid growth without matching revenue.
2. **Program comparison:** grantees whose cost per member far exceeds peers.

FIRST PROTOTYPE

A grantee risk list for the Foster Grandparent and AmeriCorps State and National programs.

SCORECARD

Fraud savings identified
Pending

Phase 1 window
Week 12
Feb 1, 2027 to Feb 5, 2027

Workstream
Shared screens

FY2026 outlays
$1.2B · budget rank 30

Leads go to
AmeriCorps OIG

WHY PRIORITY 30

Exposure	●○○○○
Public data	●●●○○
SBA method fit	●●○○○
Actionability	●●○○○

OUR REVIEW, DELIVERED WEEK 12

Grantee risk list for the Foster Grandparent and AmeriCorps State and National programs: prior OIG findings, cost per member versus peers, Form 990 revenue checks.

Every lead goes to an Inspector General or DOJ as a referral package with sources and caveats. Nothing is published.

WHAT WE ASK OF AMERICORPS

Phase 2 data: Subrecipient financial reports, timesheets.

What it enables: Unsupported costs, stipend fraud.

Access route: Each OIG.

LIMITS

Member timesheets and stipend payments are not public.

SOURCES

- GAO-26-108694: FY2025 improper payments
- USAspending agency profiles (FY2026 outlays)

Scores and plans are our judgment from public sources. Risk indicators are leads for Inspectors General or DOJ, not accusations.

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